

EUROPEAN COURT OF HUMAN RIGHTS
COUR EUROPÉENNE DES DROITS DE L'HOMME

SECOND SECTION

CASE OF YELYSHEV AND OTHERS v. RUSSIA

(Applications nos. 32180/21 and 20 others –
see appended list)

JUDGMENT

STRASBOURG

14 March 2024

This judgment is final but it may be subject to editorial revision.



In the case of Yelyshev and Others v. Russia,

The European Court of Human Rights (Second Section), sitting as a Committee composed of:

Lorraine Schembri Orland*, President*,
Frédéric Krenc,
Davor Derenčinović*, judges*,
and Viktoriya Maradudina, *Acting Deputy Section Registrar,*

Having deliberated in private on 15 February 2024,

Delivers the following judgment, which was adopted on that date:

PROCEDURE

1. The case originated in applications against Russia lodged with the Court under Article 34 of the Convention for the Protection of Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms ("the Convention") on the various dates indicated in the appended table.

2. The Russian Government ("the Government") were given notice of the applications.

THE FACTS

3. The list of applicants and the relevant details of the applications are set out in the appended table.

4. The applicants complained of the disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies. They also raised other complaints under the provisions of the Convention.

THE LAW

I. JOINDER OF THE APPLICATIONS

5. Having regard to the similar subject matter of the applications, the Court finds it appropriate to examine them jointly in a single judgment.

II. JURISDICTION

6. The Court observes that the facts giving rise to the alleged violations of the Convention occurred prior to 16 September 2022, the date on which the Russian Federation ceased to be a party to the Convention. The Court therefore decides that it has jurisdiction to examine the present applications (see *Fedotova and Others v. Russia* [GC], nos. 40792/10 and 2 others, §§ 68-73, 17 January 2023).

III. ALLEGED VIOLATION OF ARTICLE 11 OF THE CONVENTION

7. The applicants complained principally of disproportionate measures taken against them as organisers or participants of public assemblies, namely their arrest in relation to the dispersal of these assemblies and their conviction for administrative offences. They relied, expressly or in substance, on Article 11 of the Convention.

8. The Court refers to the principles established in its case-law regarding freedom of assembly (see *Kudrevičius and Others v. Lithuania* [GC], no. 37553/05, ECHR 2015, with further references) and proportionality of interference with it (see *Oya Ataman v. Turkey*, no. 74552/01, ECHR 2006-XIV, and *Hyde Park and Others v. Moldova*, no. 33482/06, 31 March 2009).

9. In the leading cases of *Frumkin v. Russia,* no. 74568/12, ECHR 2016 (extracts), *Navalnyy and Yashin v. Russia,* no. 76204/11, 4 December 2014 and *Kasparov and Others v. Russia,* no. 21613/07, 3 October 2013, the Court already found a violation in respect of issues similar to those in the present case.

10. Having examined all the material submitted to it, the Court has not found any fact or argument capable of persuading it to reach a different conclusion as to the admissibility and merits of these complaints. Having regard to its case-law on the subject, the Court considers that in the instant case the interferences with the applicants' freedom of assembly were not "necessary in a democratic society".

11. These complaints are therefore admissible and disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention.

IV. OTHER ALLEGED VIOLATIONS UNDER WELL-ESTABLISHED CASE-LAW

12. Some applicants submitted other complaints which also raised issues under the Convention and its Protocols, given the relevant well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table). These complaints are not manifestly ill-founded within the meaning of Article 35 § 3 (a) of the Convention, nor are they inadmissible on any other ground. Accordingly, they must be declared admissible.

13. Having examined all the material before it, the Court concludes that these complaints also disclose violations of the Convention and its Protocols in the light of its findings in *Lashmankin and Others v. Russia*, nos. 57818/09 and 14 others, § 489, 7 February 2017, *Butkevich v. Russia*, no. 5865/07, §§ 63-65, 13 February 2018, *Tsvetkova and Others v. Russia*, nos. 54381/08 and 5 others, §§ 115-31, 10 April 2018, and *Korneyeva v. Russia*, no. 72051/17, §§ 34-36, 8 October 2019, as to various aspects of unlawful deprivation of liberty of organisers or participants of public assemblies;

Karelin v. Russia, no. 926/08, §§ 58-85, 20 September 2016, concerning the absence of a prosecuting party in the proceedings under the Code of Administrative Offences (the CAO); *mutatis mutandis*, *Sürek v.Turkey (no. 1)* [GC], no. 26682/95, § 58, ECHR 1999-IV, and *Mariya Alekhina and Others v. Russia*, no. 38004/12, §§ 197-201, 17 July 2018, concerning administrative conviction for discreditation of the Russian Army in the context of anti-war protest actions; *Martynyuk v. Russia*, no. 13764/15, §§ 38-42, 8 October 2019, and *Tsvetkova and Others*, cited above, §§ 178-88, relating to the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal against the sentence of administrative detention.

V. REMAINING COMPLAINTS

14. Some applicants raised further additional complaints under Article 6 of the Convention concerning other aspects of fairness of the administrative-offence proceedings. In view of the findings in paragraphs above, the Court considers that there is no need to deal separately with these remaining complaints.

VI. APPLICATION OF ARTICLE 41 OF THE CONVENTION

15. Regard being had to the documents in its possession and to its case-law (see in particular *Navalnyy and Others v. Russia* [Committee], nos. 25809/17 and 14 others, § 22, 4 October 2022), the Court finds it reasonable to award the sums indicated in the appended table.

FOR THESE REASONS, THE COURT, UNANIMOUSLY,

1. *Decides* to join the applications;

2. *Holds* that it has jurisdiction to deal with these applications as they relate to the facts that took place before 16 September 2022;

3. *Declares* the complaints under Article 11 of the Convention and the other complaints under the well-established case-law of the Court, as set out in the appended table, admissible, and *finds* that there is no need to examine separately the remaining complaints under Article 6 of the Convention;

4. *Holds* that these applications disclose a breach of Article 11 of the Convention;

5. *Holds* that there has been a violation of the Convention and the Protocols thereto as regards the other complaints raised under the well-established case-law of the Court (see appended table);

6. *Holds*

(a) that the respondent State is to pay the applicants, within three months, the amounts indicated in the appended table, to be converted into the currency of the respondent State at the rate applicable at the date of settlement;

(b) that from the expiry of the above-mentioned three months until settlement simple interest shall be payable on the above amounts at a rate equal to the marginal lending rate of the European Central Bank during the default period plus three percentage points.

Done in English, and notified in writing on 14 March 2024, pursuant to Rule 77 §§ 2 and 3 of the Rules of Court.

Viktoriya Maradudina Acting Deputy Registrar	Lorraine Schembri Orland President

APPENDIX

List of applications raising complaints under Article 11 of the Convention
(disproportionate measures against organisers and participants of public assemblies)

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses (in euros)[1]
1.	32180/21 11/06/2021	**Eldar Erikovich YELYSHEV** 1997	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Ufa 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 14,000	Supreme Court of the Bashkortostan Republic 24/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 1.25 p.m. to 5.50 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision - Supreme Court of the Bashkortostan Republic, 24/03/2021	4,000
2.	38692/21 15/07/2021	**Pavel Robertovich PUSHNOV** 1968	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 17/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 1.05 p.m. on 31/01/2021 to 1.00 a.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 17/05/2021	4,000
3.	38915/21 12/07/2021	**Sergey Ivanovich GAMBARYAN** 2000	Aksenova Darya Dmitriyevna Kolomna	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 8 of CAO	administrative detention of 15 days	Moscow City Court 09/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 5.30 p.m. on 31/01/2021 to 02/02/2021, hearing in the applicant's administrative-offence case,	5,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses (in euros)[1]
								Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 09/02/2021	
4.	39335/21 22/07/2021	**Valeriy Vitalyevich PEREPELKIN** 1985	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 12/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 1.30 p.m. to 11.30 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 12/04/2021.	4,000
5.	39868/21 29/07/2021	**Revaz Davidovich GABELAYA** 1993	Pershakova Yelena Yuryevna Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	administrative detention of 15 days	Moscow City Court 04/02/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 12.45 a.m. on 31/01/2021 to 1.11 a.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 04/02/2021, Prot. 7 Art. 2 - delayed review of conviction by a higher tribunal - the sentence of administrative detention imposed on the applicant was executed immediately, on account of the lack of suspensive effect of an appeal under the CAO	5,000
6.	41309/21 30/07/2021	**Adel Radikovna GORSHENINA** 2000	Bayeva Aleksandra Nikolayevna Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Ufa 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Bashkortostan Republic 29/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) – unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 12.25 p.m. to 4.00 p.m. on 31/01/2021,	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses (in euros)[1]
								Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Supreme Court of the Bashkortostan Republic, 29/03/2021	
7.	46000/21 01/09/2021	**Kirill Vladimirovich PAVLOV** 1971	Markin Konstantin Aleksandrovich Velikiy Novgorod	Rally in support of Navalnyy Velikiy Novgorod 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	community work of 20 hours	Novgorod Regional Court 04/03/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Novgorod Regional Court, 04/03/2021	3,500
8.	47233/21 16/09/2021	**Nikita Olegovich SHIPUGIN** 2000	Memorial Human Rights Centre Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Barnaul 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Altay Regional Court 19/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 2.05 p.m. to 7.45 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Altay Regional Court, 19/03/2021	4,000
9.	47241/21 10/09/2021	**Kirill Andreyevich SLOTIN** 1998	Mezak Ernest Aleksandrovich Saint-Barthélemy-d'Anjou	Rally in support of Navalnyy Syktyvkar 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Supreme Court of the Komi Republic 10/03/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Supreme Court of the Komi Republic, 10/03/2021	3,500
10.	47243/21 10/09/2021	**Aleksey Vladimirovich MALOV** 1978	Martynova Tatyana Georgiyevna Pskov	Rally in support of Navalnyy Pskov	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Pskov Regional Court 22/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to the police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence, on 23/01/2021, while the record was only drawn up on 26/01/2021,	4,000

No.	Application no. Date of introduction	Applicant's name Year of birth	Representative's name and location	Name of the public event Location Date	Administrative offence	Penalty	Final domestic decision Court Name Date	Other complaints under well-established case-law	Amount awarded for pecuniary and non-pecuniary damage and costs and expenses (in euros)[1]
				23/01/2021				Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Pskov Regional Court, 22/03/2021	
11.	47245/21 10/09/2021	**Nikolay Aleksandrovich KUZMIN** 1980	Martynova Tatyana Georgiyevna Pskov	Rally in support of Navalnyy Pskov 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Pskov Regional Court 22/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence, as o 02.00 p.m. on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decisions: Pskov Regional Court, 22/03/2021 and 20/06/2022, Art. 10 (1) – various restrictions of the liberty of expression - On 15/03/2015 the applicant published a post on his VK social network wall containing a video of Maria Ovsannikova's public anti-war protest on TV and commented as follows: "Very brave woman". On 17/04/2022 the applicant was arrested and escorted to the police station where he was charged with and then convicted and sentenced to an administrative fine of RUB 30,000 for public actions aimed at discrediting the use of the Russian Armed Forces, under Art. 20.3.3 § 1 of the CAO; final decision: 20/06/2022, Pskov Regional Court	5,000
12.	48039/21 09/09/2021	**Igor Olegovich GOLOVIN** 1999	Bochilo Anna Yevgenyevna Barnaul	Rally in support of Navalnyy Kursk 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Kursk Regional Court 02/04/2021	Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Kursk Regional Court, 02/04/2021.	3,500

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13.	50102/21 21/09/2021	**Yekaterina Anatolyevna NAGORNAYA** 2002	Aksenova Darya Dmitriyevna Kolomna	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 15,000	Moscow City Court 22/03/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence, on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 22/03/2021	4,000
14.	54914/21 14/10/2021	**Solomon Semenovich SHLOSMAN** 1991	Aksenova Darya Dmitriyevna Kolomna	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 20/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence, on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 20/04/2021	4,000
15.	54926/21 14/10/2021	**Dmitriy Aleksandrovich YURYEV** 1995	Aksenova Darya Dmitriyevna Kolomna	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 21/07/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence, detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 12.15 p.m. to 9.30 p.m. on 31/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 21/07/2021	4,000
16.	57075/21 26/10/2021	**Elza Rafilevna MAYER** 1995	Baranova Natalya Andreyevna Moscow	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 20,000	Moscow City Court 26/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 4.00 p.m. to 11.00 p.m. on 23/01/2021, the applicant spent 2 hours in the police van, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 26/04/2021	4,000

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17.	57677/21 26/10/2021	**Aleksey Sergeyevich TABACHINSKIY** 1993	Glukhov Aleksey Vladimirovich Novocheboksarsk	Rally in support of Navalnyy Samara 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Samara Regional Court 29/04/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 3.50 p.m. to 9.55 p.m. on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Samara Regional Court, 29/04/2021	4,000
18.	58021/21 27/10/2021	**Yelena Pavlovna SAMOKHVALOVA** 1977	Bochilo Anna Yevgenyevna Barnaul	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Moscow City Court 11/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 3.30 p.m. to 7.30 p.m. on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 11/05/2021	4,000
19.	58023/21 27/10/2021	**Natalya Yevgenyevna KOSHURNIKOVA** 1969	Bochilo Anna Yevgenyevna Barnaul	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	community works of 55 hours	Moscow City Court 21/06/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 2.15 p.m. on 31/01/2021 to 5.10 a.m. on 01/02/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 21/06/2021	4,000

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20.	58677/21 12/11/2021	**Nataliya Dmitriyevna RUSAKOVICH** 1998	Glukhov Aleksey Vladimirovich Novocheboksarsk	Rally in support of Navalnyy Samara 23/01/2021	article 20.2 § 5 of CAO	fine of RUB 10,000	Samara Regional Court 13/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 2.30 p.m. to 8.00 p.m. on 23/01/2021, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Samara Regional Court, 13/05/2021	4,000
21.	59239/21 12/11/2021	**Ilya Romanovich LITVINTSEV** 1995	Aksenova Darya Dmitriyevna Kolomna	Rally in support of Navalnyy Moscow 31/01/2021	article 20.2 § 6.1 of CAO	administrative detention of 10 days	Moscow City Court 13/05/2021	Art. 5 (1) - unlawful deprivation of liberty: escorting to a police station for the purpose of drawing up a record of administrative offence; detention in excess of 3 hours and without "exceptional circumstances", from 2.10 p.m. on 31/01/2021 to 1.15 p.m. on 01/02/2021, hearing in the applicant's administrative-offence case, Art. 6 (1) - lack of impartiality of the tribunal in view of the absence of a prosecuting party in administrative-offence proceedings - final decision: Moscow City Court, 13/05/2021	5,000

[1] Plus any tax that may be chargeable to the applicants.